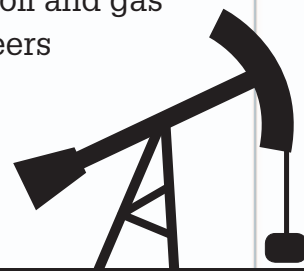


DRILLING ENGINEER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Drilling engineers are responsible for planning, coordinating, and managing oil and gas drilling operations. In this role, you will use a combination of geology, physics, and engineering to design, plan, and oversee the drilling of an oil and gas well. The majority of drilling engineers work for oil and gas companies, while others may work for consultant drilling contractors.



SALARY

Drilling engineer ★★★★★

Senior drilling engineer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Most jobs in multinational companies and consultancies • Experienced drilling engineers very well paid • Number of jobs depends on current economic conditions

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Geology • Physics • Chemistry • Mathematics • Engineering • Geography • Languages • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in a subject such as engineering, physics, or geology, or a related postgraduate degree, is required.



LIFESTYLE Most drilling engineers work long hours. Extended periods away from home and travel to drilling sites, possibly overseas, are common.



LOCATION Drilling engineers should expect to shuttle between the office and the wellsite (either an offshore or land-based drilling rig).



THE REALITIES Working on rigs may require travel by helicopter or boat. The work is physically challenging, and may involve dangerous conditions.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **GEOSCIENTIST** *see pp. 148–149*
- ▶ **MECHANICAL ENGINEER** *see pp. 182–183*
- ▶ **ENERGY ENGINEER** Researches and develops methods of generating energy from different sources, including renewable forms, such as wind, wave, geothermal, and solar power.
- ▶ **MARINE ENGINEER** Designs, builds, and tests oil rigs, pipelines, remotely operated vehicles, ships, boats, and support vessels for the oil, gas, and marine-leisure industries.
- ▶ **MINING ENGINEER** Plans, designs, and monitors new and existing mining and quarrying sites. Mining engineers are also responsible for ensuring that sites are safe and working efficiently.

The oil and gas sectors provide the raw materials for almost half the world's forms of energy.

